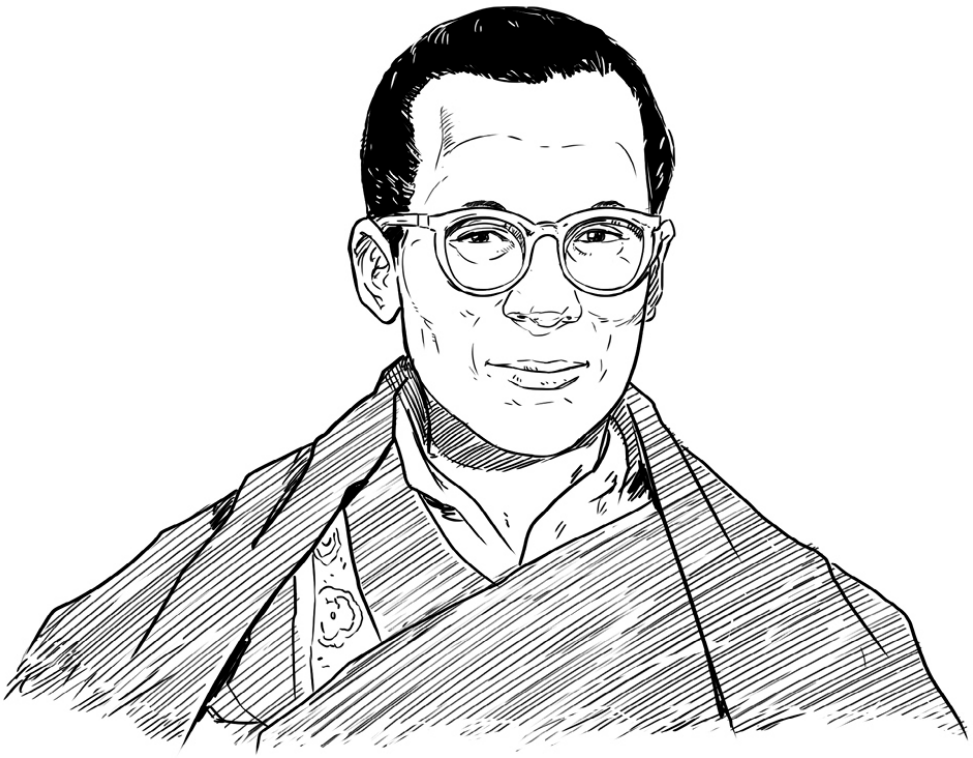


He was also glad to be more connected to the world outside Tibet. Now safely in India, he asked the United Nations (UN)—an international group that works for peace and human rights—for help protecting the Tibetan people from China. Human rights are the rights of all people—no matter what nation they are from, what religion they practice, or the color of their skin—to have equality, safety, fairness, and freedom. The UN spoke out in support of Tibetans and asked the Chinese government to respect these human rights.

During the Dalai Lama's first year in exile, about eighty thousand more Tibetans escaped to India and joined him. As their leader, he set up a government-in-exile. The government was based on both Buddhist ideas and democratic ones— such as the freedom to say what you want, freedom to believe what you want, and the freedom to meet together in groups.